Northwind Tech Employee Handbook

Welcome to Northwind Tech. This handbook explains how we work, what you can expect from us and what we expect from you. It applies to all full-time, part-time and contract employees across our Bengaluru, Pune, Hyderabad and Gurugram offices. Where a policy document is more detailed than this handbook, the policy document prevails.

1. About Northwind Tech

Northwind Tech builds supply-chain analytics software for mid-sized manufacturers. Founded in 2014, we now employ around 500 people across Engineering, Product, Sales, Customer Success, Marketing, Finance, People Operations and IT. Our values are Customer Obsession, Ownership, Candour and Craft. We are a hybrid company: most teams work from the office three days a week and from home two days a week. Every employee is assigned a buddy for their first 60 days and a manager who holds weekly one-to-ones. Performance is reviewed twice a year in April and October.

2. Working hours and attendance

Core hours are 10:00 to 16:00 IST. Standard working time is 40 hours per week, Monday to Friday. Employees record attendance in the People Portal; work-from-home days are recorded as WFH. Repeated unrecorded absence is treated as unauthorised leave.

3. Probation, notice period and exit

New joiners are on probation for 90 days. The notice period is 60 days for all employees after probation and 15 days during probation. Notice must be given in writing through the People Portal. The last working day is agreed with your manager, and all company equipment must be returned to IT on or before that day. Final settlement is paid within 30 days of exit.

4. Leave overview

Northwind offers casual leave, sick leave, earned leave, maternity and paternity leave, and bereavement leave. Full details, entitlements and the carry-forward rules are in the Leave Policy. In summary, employees receive 12 casual leaves per year, 8 sick leaves per year and 15 earned leaves per year.

5. Hybrid work

Employees may work from home up to 2 days per week with manager approval, as set out in the WFH & Travel Policy. Fully remote arrangements require written approval from the department head and People Operations.

6. Compensation and payroll

Salaries are paid on the last working day of each month into the bank account registered in the People Portal. Payslips are available in the portal. Tax declarations are collected in April and proofs in January. Questions about payroll go to payroll@northwind.example.

7. Benefits overview

All employees are covered by group health insurance of Rs. 5,00,000 per family per year, group term life insurance of 3x annual CTC, and a Provident Fund contribution as per statute. See the Benefits Summary for details, including the wellness allowance.

8. Code of conduct

We expect honesty, respect and professionalism. Harassment, discrimination and retaliation are not tolerated.

Concerns can be raised confidentially with People Operations (hr@northwind.example) or through the anonymous Speak Up line. See the Code of Conduct for the full policy.

9. Information security

Use your Northwind laptop for all work. Enable full-disk encryption and the company VPN. Never share passwords. Report lost devices to it-helpdesk@northwind.example within 2 hours. Customer data may not be copied to personal devices or personal cloud storage.

10. Learning and development

Each employee has an annual learning budget of Rs. 40,000 for courses, books and conferences, approved by their manager. Northwind also runs an internal engineering academy every quarter.

11. First-week checklist for new joiners

- Day 1: collect your laptop and ID card from IT at the reception desk; complete e-signature of the offer and NDA.
- Day 1: set up email, Slack, the People Portal and the VPN using the IT Onboarding Guide.
- Day 2: meet your buddy and manager; review your 30-60-90 day plan.
- Day 3: complete the mandatory Code of Conduct and Information Security e-learning (60 minutes).
- Day 4: submit bank details, PAN and tax declaration in the People Portal.
- Day 5: attend the Northwind Welcome session (every Friday, 11:00, Town Hall room or Zoom).

12. Useful contacts

Topic	Contact	Hours
HR / People Operations	hr@northwind.example	Mon-Fri 09:30-18:00
IT helpdesk	it-helpdesk@northwind.example	Mon-Sat 08:00-20:00
Payroll	payroll@northwind.example	Mon-Fri 10:00-17:00
Facilities	facilities@northwind.example	Mon-Fri 08:00-19:00
Speak Up line (anonymous)	speakup.northwind.example	24x7

13. Appendix 1: Office locations

This appendix provides supporting detail for the section referenced above. Where an appendix conflicts with a policy document, the policy document prevails. Appendices are reviewed annually by People Operations and Legal. For questions contact hr@northwind.example. This appendix provides supporting detail for the section referenced above. Where an appendix conflicts with a policy document, the policy document prevails. Appendices are reviewed annually by People Operations and Legal. For questions contact hr@northwind.example. This appendix provides supporting detail for the section referenced above. Where an appendix conflicts with a policy document, the policy document prevails. Appendices are reviewed annually by People Operations and Legal. For questions contact hr@northwind.example.

14. Appendix 2: Meeting room etiquette

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15. Appendix 3: Expense categories

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16. Appendix 4: Travel classes

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17. Appendix 5: Asset tagging

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18. Appendix 6: Data classification

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19. Appendix 7: Incident reporting

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20. Appendix 8: Grievance process

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21. Appendix 9: Recognition programme

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22. Appendix 10: Referral bonus

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23. Appendix 11: Sabbatical policy

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24. Appendix 12: Alumni network

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25. Appendix 13: Glossary

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